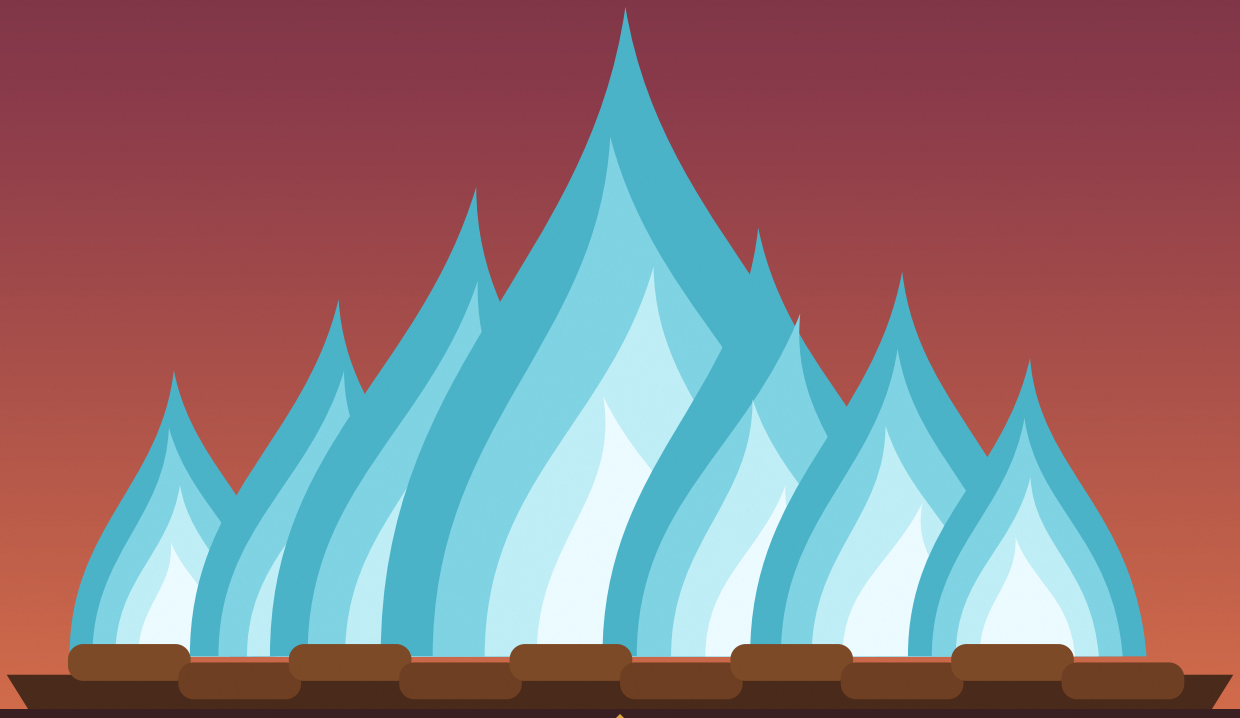
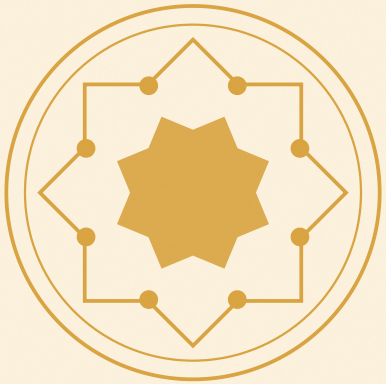
STORIES FROM THE QURAN · 2

Ibrahim and the Fire

إبراهيم والنار





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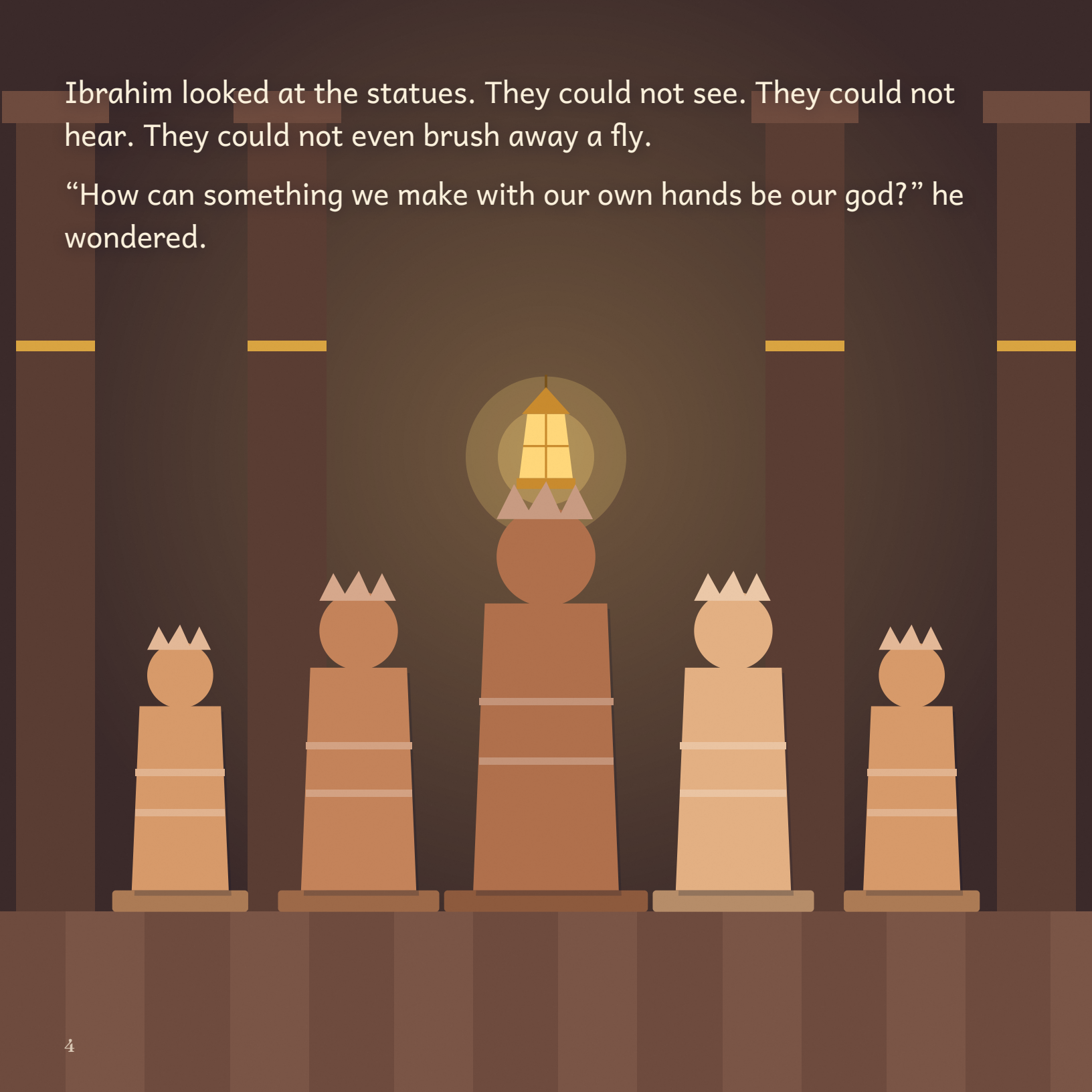
Long ago, in a land between two great rivers, there lived a boy named Ibrahim (peace be upon him).

His father, Azar, carved statues out of wood and stone. People bought them, set them up, and bowed down to them.



Ibrahim looked at the statues. They could not see. They could not hear. They could not even brush away a fly.

“How can something we make with our own hands be our god?” he wondered.



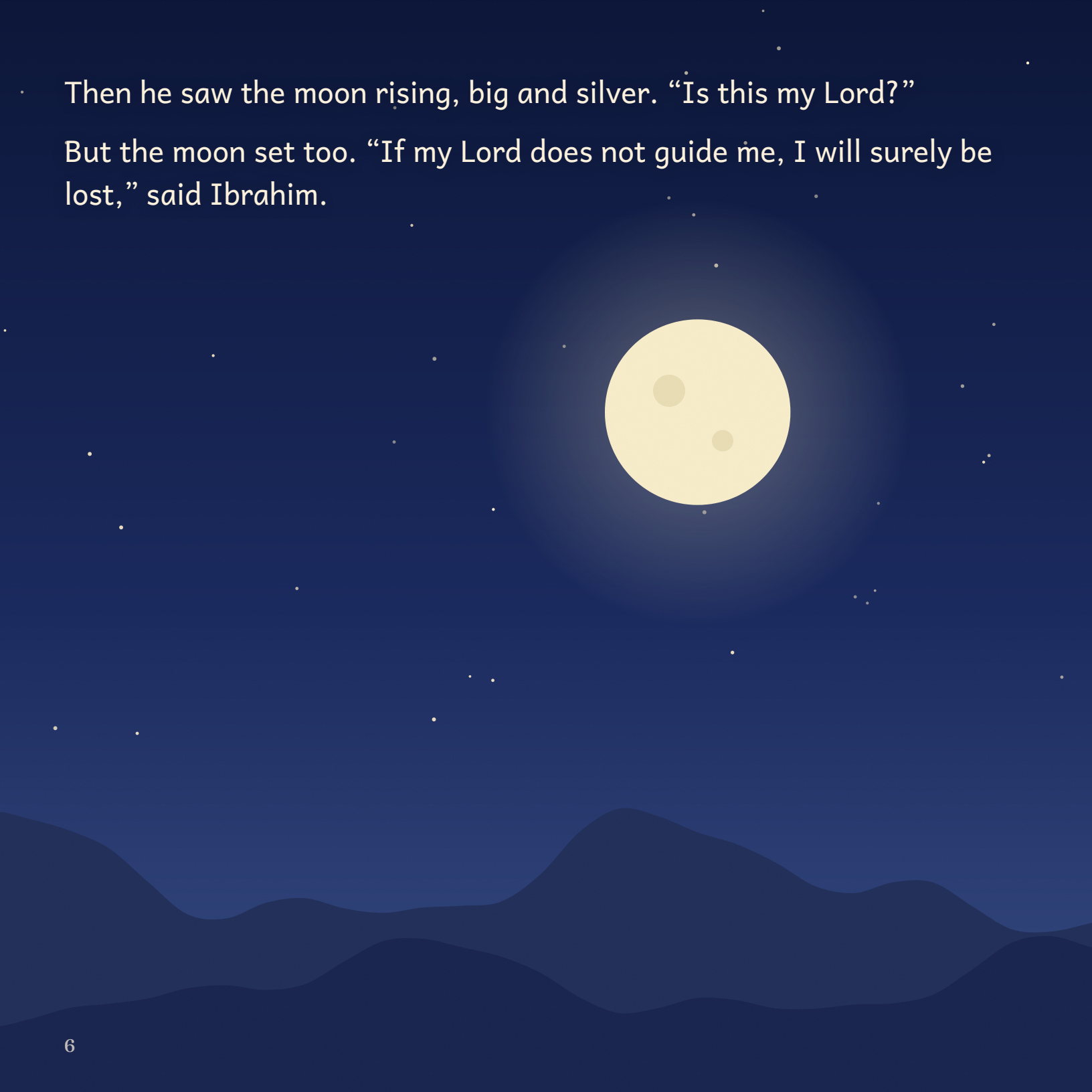
One night Ibrahim saw a bright star shining. “Is this my Lord?” he asked.

But the star set and was gone. “I do not love things that disappear,” said Ibrahim.



Then he saw the moon rising, big and silver. “Is this my Lord?”

But the moon set too. “If my Lord does not guide me, I will surely be lost,” said Ibrahim.



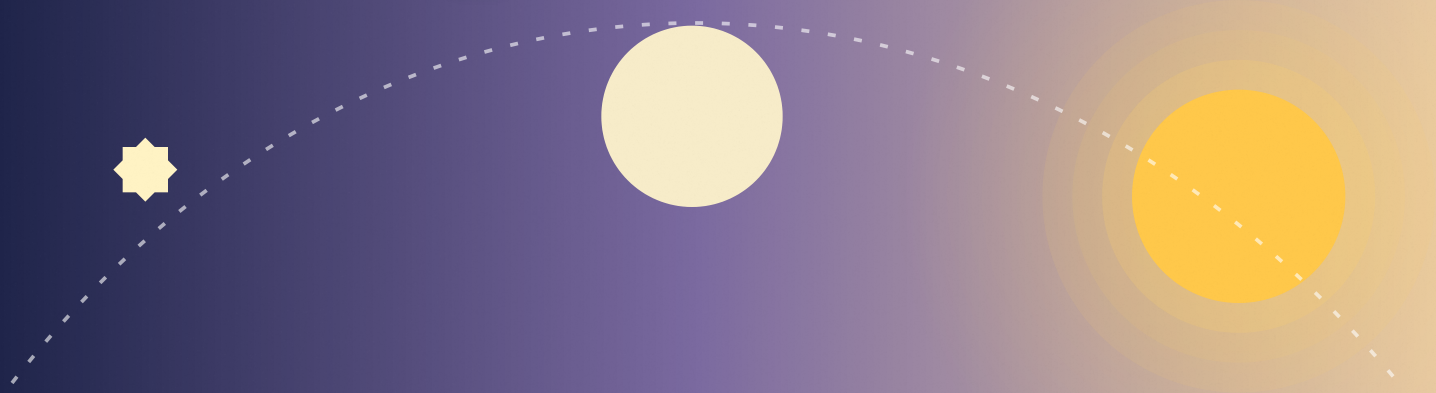
In the morning the sun rose, huge and golden. “This must be my Lord! This is the biggest of all!”

But in the evening the sun set as well.



Then Ibrahim said: “I turn my face to the One who made the heavens and the earth.”

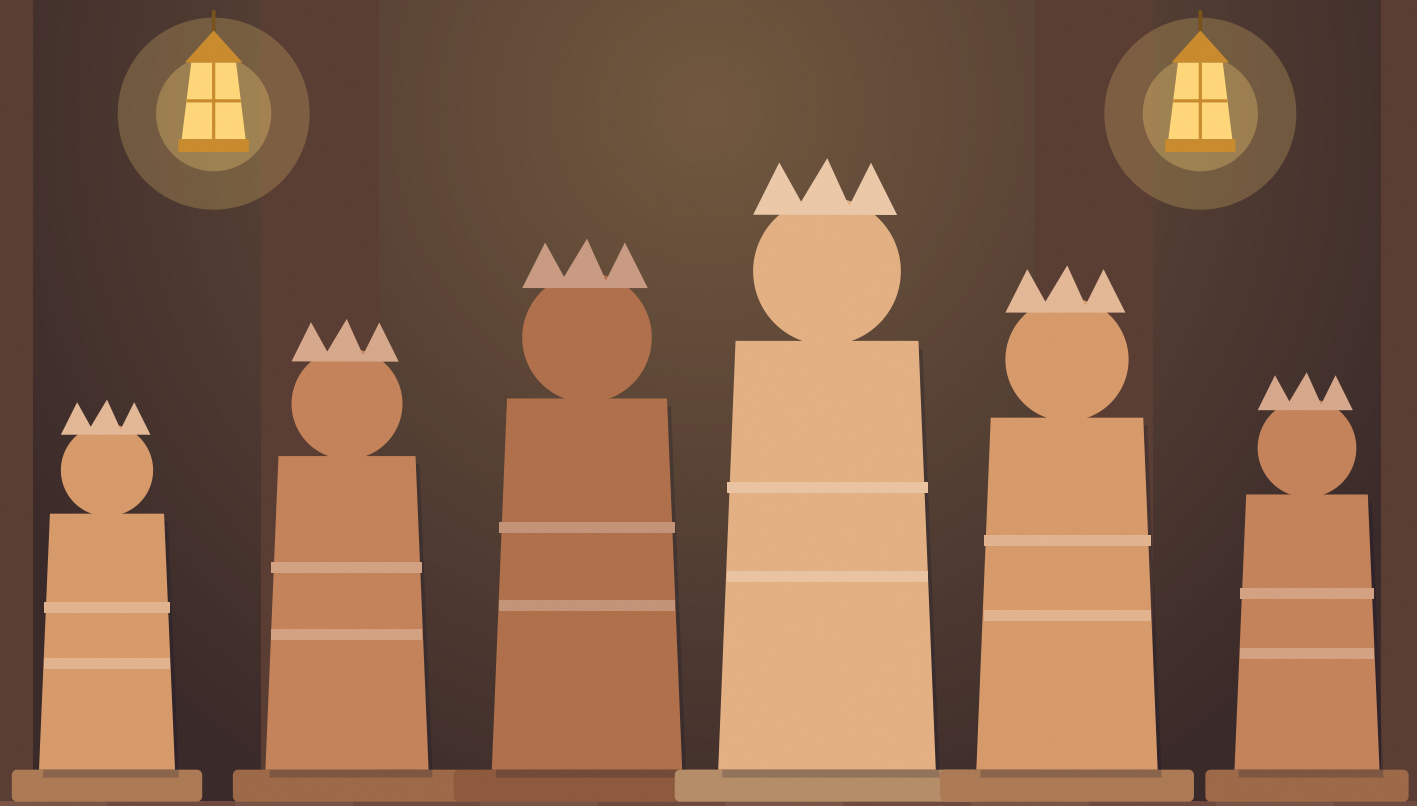
The star, the moon and the sun all come and go. Allah made them all, and Allah never disappears.



Ibrahim went to his people. “What are these statues you sit in front of all day?”

“We found our fathers worshipping them,” they said.

“Then you and your fathers have been clearly wrong,” said Ibrahim.



One day the people went out of the city for a festival, and the temple was empty. Ibrahim went in. Plates of food sat in front of the statues.

"Won't you eat?" he asked them. "Why don't you speak?"

Of course, they said nothing.



So Ibrahim broke the statues into pieces, all of them except the biggest one.



When the people came back, they cried, “Who did this to our gods?”

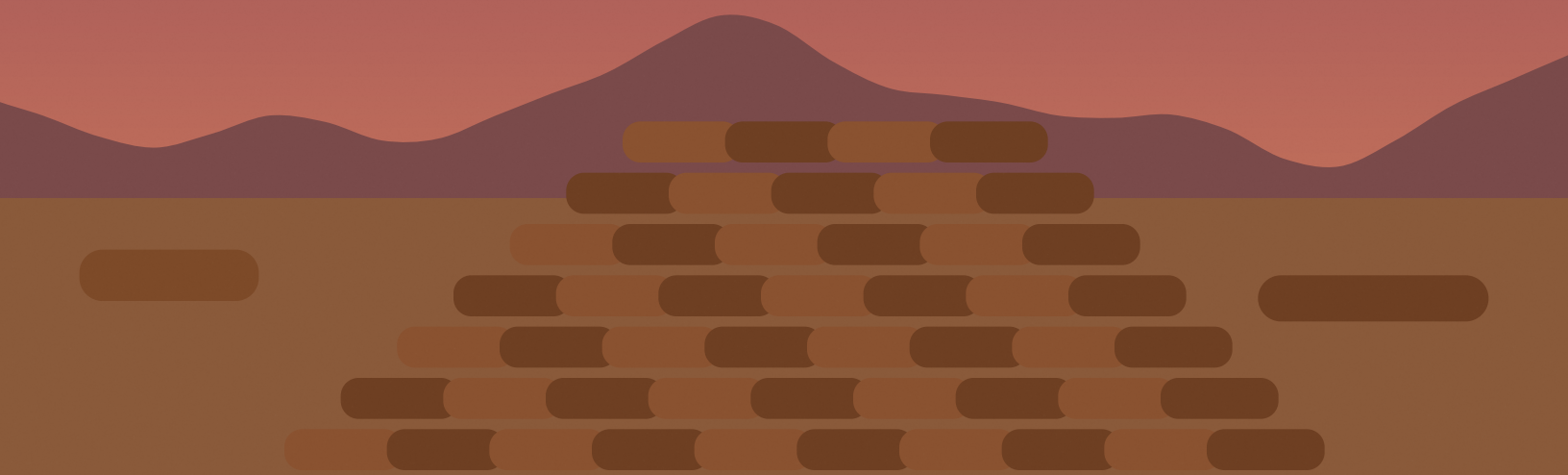
“Ask them,” said Ibrahim, “if they can speak! Perhaps the biggest one did it.”

The people looked down. They knew statues cannot speak.



But instead of listening, they grew angry. “Burn him!” they shouted. “Protect your gods!”

They gathered wood, more and more, and built an enormous fire.



The fire roared so high and hot that no one could go near it. And they threw Ibrahim into the flames.



Then Allah said:

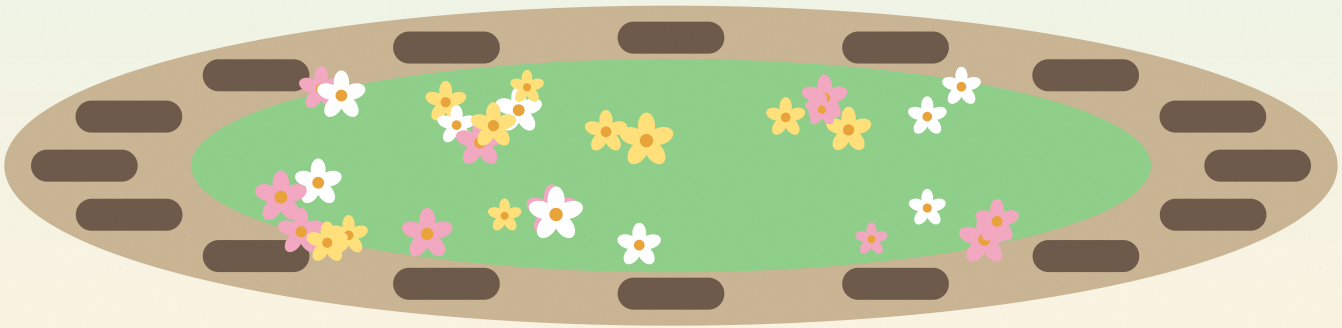
“O fire, be cool, and safe, for Ibrahim!”

And the fire obeyed.



The fire did not hurt Ibrahim at all. He walked out safe and well.

The people had made a plan against him, but Allah made their plan fail.



Many years later, Ibrahim and his son Isma'il were in a dry valley among bare mountains. Allah showed them where to build a House for worshipping Him alone.

Stone by stone, they raised its walls.

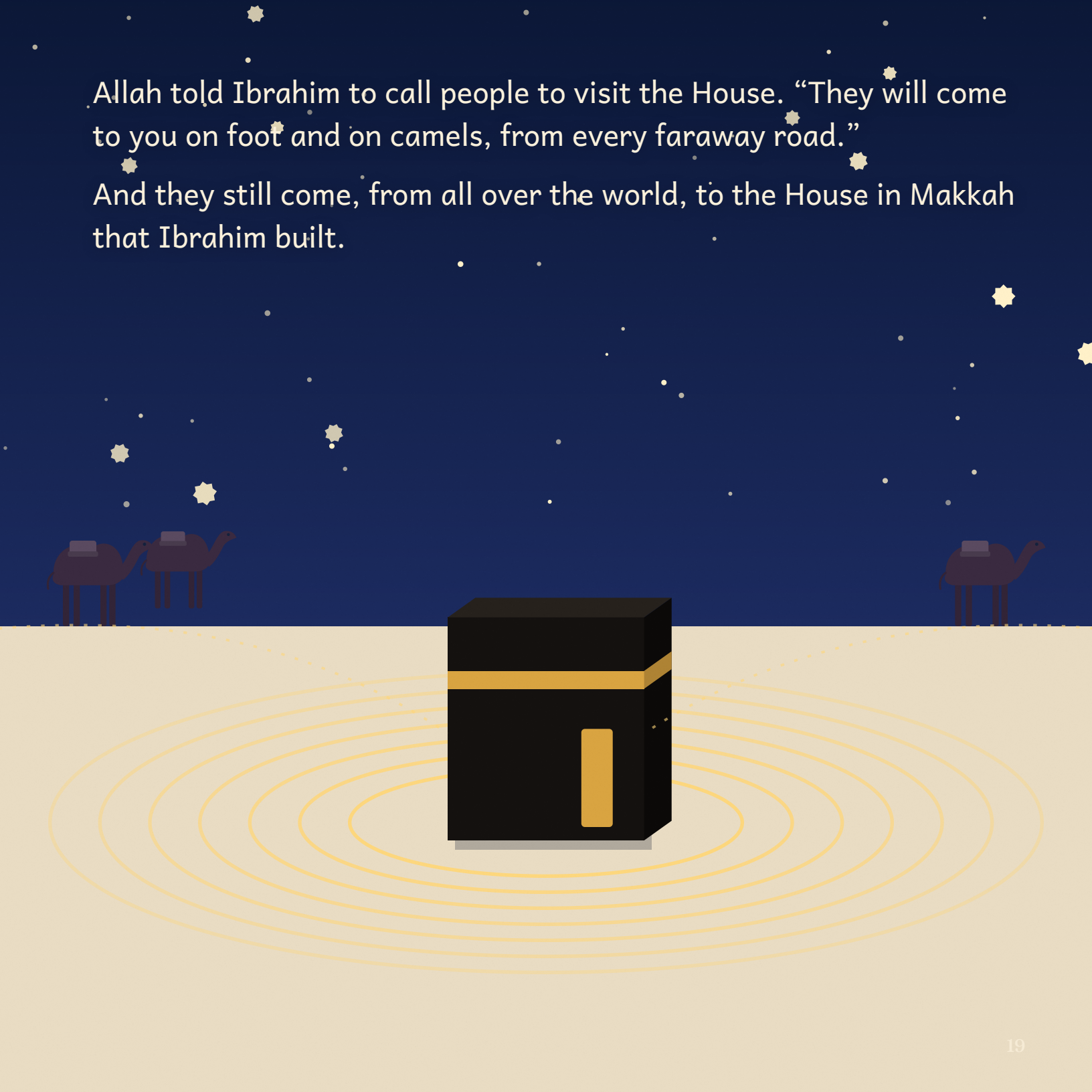


As they worked, they prayed together: “Our Lord, accept this from us. You are the All-Hearing, the All-Knowing.”



Allah told Ibrahim to call people to visit the House. “They will come to you on foot and on camels, from every faraway road.”

And they still come, from all over the world, to the House in Makkah that Ibrahim built.



Say Ibrahim's prayer

Ibrahim and Isma'il said it while they built. You can say it when you finish something good.

رَبَّنَا تَقَبَّلْ مِنَّآ

Rabbanā taqabbal minnā

Our Lord, accept this from us.

إِنَّكَ أَنتَ ٱلسَّمِيعُ ٱلْعَلِيمُ

innaka antas-samī'ul-'alīm

You are the All-Hearing, the All-Knowing.

From Surah Al-Baqarah, 2:127

What does the story teach us?



Think for yourself.

Ibrahim looked at the star, the moon and the sun, and asked who made them.



Be brave with the truth.

Ibrahim told his people the truth, even when it was hard.



Allah protects those who trust Him.

Even fire obeys Allah.

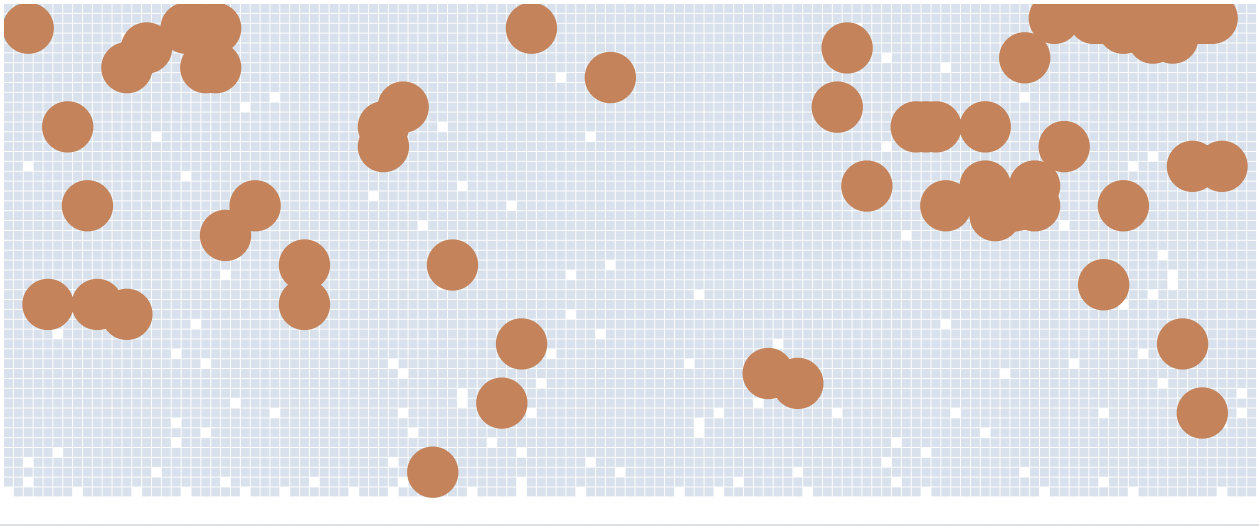


Ask Allah to accept your good work.

Ibrahim and Isma'il prayed while they built.

Did you know?

Ibrahim's name appears **69** times. Only Musa is named more often. Surah 14 is named after him: **Surah Ibrahim**.



Every verse of the Quran is one tiny square, starting at the top right like a page of the Quran. Each dot is a verse that names Ibrahim.

Allah took Ibrahim as a friend, *a khalīl* (4:125).

Look closer

Some pictures hide a secret from the Quran itself. Go back and find them.

p. 5–7 The star, the moon and the sun. The same three appear again in Yusuf's dream (12:4). Find them in book 3.

p. 10 Plates of food in front of the statues. Ibrahim asked them, "Won't you eat?" (37:91).

p. 11 Only the biggest statue is left standing (21:58). The axe hanging on it comes from the old commentaries.

p. 15 Blue flames. Allah said "cool" and then "safe" (21:69). Commentators said "safe" was added so the fire would not become harmfully cold.

p. 18 The prayer ends with two of Allah's names side by side, the All-Hearing and the All-Knowing. 32 verses of the Quran end with this same pair.

p. 19 Seven rings of light: pilgrims walk around the House seven times. The camels on the roads are from 22:27.

For parents

Where the story is told. Al-An'am 6:74–83 (the star, the moon and the sun), Maryam 19:41–48, Al-Anbiya 21:51–70, As-Saffat 37:83–98 (the statues and the fire), Al-Baqarah 2:124–129 and Al-Hajj 22:26–27 (the House).

Told in simple words. This is a retelling for young children, not a translation. Some details come from the classical commentaries rather than the verses: that the people were away at a festival (37:88–90 points to it), and the axe hung on the largest statue. Many scholars read 6:76–78 as Ibrahim showing his people their error, rather than his own searching; the retelling keeps the words of the verses.

The pictures. By custom, no prophet is drawn, and in this series no person at all. The pictures show the places, the light and the creatures, so your child can picture the story around them.

Talk about it. Ibrahim asked good questions. What is a question you have about Allah, or about the world?

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Illustrators welcome. These first pictures are a starting point. Artists are invited to redraw any book; the Books page of the Quran Atlas has a brief for every page.

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